

Rui Ibarra

Director Platform Engineer

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Platform engineering leader with 18 years of experience delivering scalable industrial-automation systems. Former secondary-school physics teacher who transitioned into software via a self-studied bootcamp and open-source contributions. Passionate about building reliable CI/CD pipelines, observability stacks, and edge-compute solutions for manufacturing clients.

EXPERIENCE

2020 - Present

Director, Platform Engineering

Siemens Industrial Automation, Bogotá, Colombia (remote)

- Led a platform team of 12 engineers delivering a Kubernetes-based edge platform that reduced deployment time for factory-floor applications from 2 weeks to 4 hours, serving 35+ manufacturing sites across Latin America.
- Defined and instituted SLOs (99.9% availability, <100ms latency) for the internal MQTT broker handling 2.5M messages/day, achieving 99.95% uptime in FY2024.
- Introduced GitOps workflow with ArgoCD and Helm, cutting configuration drift incidents by 78% year-over-year.
- Mentored 6 senior engineers through internal leadership program; 3 promoted to Staff level within 18 months.
- Managed vendor relationships with Azure and AWS, negotiating a 22% cost reduction on reserved instances while maintaining performance SLAs.

2015 - 2020

Principal Platform Engineer

Red Hat (OpenShift Consulting), Remote (based in Lisbon, Portugal)

- Architected OpenShift-based CI/CD pipelines for a European automotive supplier, enabling 150+ daily builds and cutting release cycle from monthly to weekly.
- Authored internal training material on service mesh (Istio) adopted across 4 consulting squads, upskilling 40+ consultants.
- Led a cross-border incident response team that reduced MTTR for production outages from 4.2h to 1.1h over 6 months.

2012 - 2015

Platform Consultant

Freelance / Contract, Remote

- Built container-based monitoring stack (Prometheus + Grafana) for a fintech startup, increasing observable metrics coverage from 30% to 95%.
- Automated infrastructure provisioning with Terraform for 3 clients, reducing environment spin-up time from days to under 20 minutes.

2008 - 2012

Open-Source Contributor & Teacher

Self-taught / Open Source, Online

- Transitioned from teaching physics at a public high school in Porto to software engineering by completing a 6-month full-stack bootcamp (self-funded) and contributing to Kubernetes SIG-Docs.
- Maintained a popular Portuguese-language blog on DevOps practices, averaging 5k monthly readers; translated official Docker docs into Portuguese.

EDUCATION

2011

Certificate, Cloud Native Computing Foundations, Computer Science (continuing education)

Technical University of Munich (TU München) (TUM)

2007

B.Sc., Physics Education, Physics & Education

Universidade do Porto (UP)

SKILLS

Technical

Kubernetes · Istio · Terraform · Prometheus · Grafana · Jaeger · Python (FastAPI, Celery) · Go · Docker · Helm · GitLab CI · Jenkins X · MQTT · OPC UA · EdgeX Foundry · Linux (RHEL, Ubuntu) · AWS (EKS, RDS, S3, Lambda) · Azure IoT Hub · C/C++ (embedded) · REST/gRPC · SQL (PostgreSQL, TimescaleDB) · NoSQL (Cassandra, Redis) · Chaos Engineering · Site Reliability Engineering (SLO/SLI) · Technical mentoring · Agile/SAFe

Languages

Portuguese (native) · Spanish (fluent) · English (professional working proficiency) · French (basic)